CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

# STUDY MATERIALS - 16

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

## Read the following message.

Dear Peter,

I feel bad about not being there for my little brother's big day today—you're finally sixteen! At last you can learn to drive! You'll soon be receiving a package in the mail that will hopefully make up for my absence. I won't ruin the surprise, but it's something to do with music. I found it during my travels in South America.

Speaking of music, Mom and Dad said you're getting really good at guitar! I guess those lessons paid off. I always wanted to learn as well, but I was never as passionate about music as you. You'll have to teach me some chords when I get back home next month.

As for me, traveling has been incredible. I've just spent the past week exploring the Ecuadorian Amazon with local guides. The rainforest grows on you. At first, I found it a bit intimidating with the deadly insects and intense weather changes. But soon I started seeing the beauty of it all; I could peer under a leaf and come across rainbow-coloured insects, and, when looking overhead, I could see a flock of beautiful, colourful parrots passing by. Everything has been great so far, except when I was bitten by a black ant the size of my thumb. Apparently it's called a Bullet Ant because being bitten feels like getting shot! It certainly was the worst pain I've ever experienced. Still, I took a picture of it anyway and also one of my swollen arm. I'm fine now and ready for more adventures.

I'm currently in Quito, the capital city of Ecuador and also my final stop. It was only a 20-minute plane ride from the rainforest. The weather is pleasantly different: dry and cool. The people are amazing! Everyone is very welcoming and helpful. When I first got here, I didn't have a map, so I walked into a store and asked the shop owner where my hostel was. She couldn't really speak English, so she locked up her shop and took me all the way there, which was 2 kilometres away! Amazing! If only people were like that back home!

I can't wait to see you. I promise we'll celebrate your birthday properly when I return!

Susie

## Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. Susie _____
- ◯ will be back for Peter's birthday.
- ◯ sent Peter a birthday gift.
- ◯ will travel to South America.
- ◯ forgot Peter's birthday.

2. Peter _____
- ◯ has had some guitar lessons.
- ◯ is teaching guitar lessons.
- ◯ hopes to play the guitar.
- ◯ got a guitar from his parents.

3. Susie _____
- ◯ visited the jungle with Ecuadorian guides.
- ◯ is traveling with friends to the local jungle.
- ◯ enjoyed the warm jungle weather.
- ◯ was shot during her trip to the rainforest.

4. Susie _____
- ◯ fell instantly in love with the rainforest.
- ◯ enjoyed the rainforest's weather.
- ◯ delighted in the sounds of the rainforest.
- ◯ began to enjoy the rainforest.

5. Susie is now _____
- ◯ packing to return home.
- ◯ enjoying the last part of her trip.
- ◯ flying to the capital city.
- ◯ exploring the Ecuadorian jungle.

6. In Quito, Susie was surprised by the _____
- ◯ people's goodwill.
- ◯ distance to the hostel.
- ◯ cooler weather.
- ◯ availability of maps.

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PART 1

## Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Hey Susie,

You're right that I 7. _____ now. The trouble is that it's really expensive. Since you'll be home soon, I figured out a great solution. You can teach me in exchange for the 8. _____ you want.

I'm sorry to hear about your nasty experience in the jungle. I just googled the ant! It looks huge, and I read that its bite can be 9. _____ . You may want to see a doctor when you get home.

By the way, I wonder if that Ecuadorian shopkeeper was just 10. _____ because you were a foreigner. Do you think she would shut up her business and 11. _____ if you lived in Quito?

Finally, Mom says to email her and tell her when your flight gets in.
Love,

Peter

7. ◯ want to visit Ecuador
   ◯ am learning guitar
   ◯ can learn to drive
   ◯ am celebrating my birthday

8. ◯ driving lessons
   ◯ package
   ◯ guitar lessons
   ◯ foreign adventures

9. ◯ harmful
   ◯ harmless
   ◯ itchy
   ◯ insignificant

10. ◯ being friendly
    ◯ selling a map
    ◯ asking for help
    ◯ being uncooperative

11. ◯ show the way
    ◯ give directions
    ◯ take a rest
    ◯ find a map

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PART 2

# Michael Adam Jenson

5/30/2015

6919 182 Street, Oakridge, British Columbia
789-555-1234
majenson@email.com

## OBJECTIVES

To obtain a full-time position as a cashier, which will allow me to gain experience, expand my skill set, and pursue leadership opportunities.

## SKILLS PROFILE

- More than 5 years of experience in customer service
- Proven record of accurately completing cash transactions
- Experienced in operating point of sale systems
- Excellent verbal and written communication skills

## EDUCATION

Upper Heights High School, Maggieville, Alberta — June 2005

- Dogwood High School Diploma, GPA 3.2
- Extracurricular Activities: Intramural Volleyball, Theatrical Club, Yearbook Committee

## RECENT EXPERIENCE

Cashier | City Foods, Oakridge, BC — May 2009 – Present

- Completed grocery transactions efficiently while maintaining a clean work area to meet FoodSafe standards.
- Received an award for surpassing weekly sales targets for the "Deal of the Week."

Cashier | Willow Video, Oakridge, BC — February 2005 – April 2009

- Performed cash, debit, and credit transactions while greeting guests and providing excellent customer service.
- Promoted the company's customer loyalty program as well as offers and sales.

## ACTIVITIES

- Volunteering at the Oakridge Red Cross.
- Learning new languages, including French and German.
- Regular participant of the Oakridge library book club.
- Member of the regional synchronized swimming team.

REFERENCES AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST

**Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks**

Subject: Job Application
To: Michael Jenson
From: Alfonso Copelli

Dear Michael,

It was a pleasure to meet you yesterday. Thank you for dropping off your 1. _____ for the position of cashier at Alfonso's Groceries. Based on your prior 2. _____ experience, I'd like to invite you for an interview.

My company will soon be opening two more locations, and I need to increase my team. I'm seeking an employee who is already familiar with 3. _____ , is a quick learner, and has good interpersonal skills. I am also looking for people who are good at 4. _____ , which may come in handy when greeting customers.

Could you please provide the name and contact information for your current supervisor at 5. _____ for a reference? I will be holding interviews next Tuesday afternoon between 1:00 p.m. - 6:00 p.m. Please let me know what time is most convenient for you. The interview will likely last 30 to 45 minutes.

Kind regards,

Alfonso Copelli

1. ◯ contact
   ◯ invitation
   ◯ application
   ◯ advertisement

2. ◯ customer service
   ◯ employee training
   ◯ sales marketing
   ◯ active volunteering

3. ◯ cash registers
   ◯ commercial policies
   ◯ grocery stock
   ◯ imported products

4. ◯ additional languages
   ◯ managing others
   ◯ marketing reports
   ◯ using computers

5. ◯ City Foods
   ◯ Drumwood High
   ◯ FoodSafe
   ◯ Willow Video

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PART 2

## Choose the best option.

6. Michael applied for the job _____

- ◯ in person.
- ◯ online.
- ◯ through a friend.
- ◯ through a recruiter.

7. Alfonso's Groceries is _____

- ◯ reorganizing.
- ◯ expanding.
- ◯ relocating.
- ◯ downsizing.

8. The purpose of the email is to _____

- ◯ arrange an interview.
- ◯ discuss a new reference.
- ◯ inquire about a service.
- ◯ offer someone a job.

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PART 3

## Read the following passage.

**A.** There are many National Historic Sites in Canada, but few are as popular as the Fortress of Louisbourg in Cape Breton, Nova Scotia. It's the third most popular Parks Canada site in the Atlantic Provinces, and the tenth Canada wide. Louisbourg attracts almost 200,000 visitors annually, partly because of its location near the world-famous Cape Breton Highlands National Park, but also because of its history. In the 17th and 18th centuries, the French and British competed for control of Atlantic Canada and its thriving cod fisheries based in Louisbourg. At this time, Louisbourg was a centre of commerce that traded cod for manufactured goods from France, New England, and the West Indies, making this maritime resource the region's primary driver for economic growth.

**B.** Construction of the fortified seaport of Louisbourg began in 1713. It became an important military base with a permanent garrison and a settled French population of about 8,000 by 1744. However, it kept changing hands between France and Britain, depending on which country won the most recent war. In 1745 the British won, and the French population returned to France. Three years later, Louisbourg reverted to France, and the French population returned to Louisbourg. In 1758 the British attacked yet again, re-capturing the fortress in only seven weeks. This time British domination was permanent. The fortifications were destroyed and the town abandoned. This, plus the capture of Quebec in 1759 and Montreal in 1760, ended France's power in North America.

**C.** In the early 1960s, the Government of Canada began a $25 million project to reconstruct about one-quarter of the original Louisbourg town and fortifications. The buildings, yards, gardens, and streets were recreated as they were in 1744. At first there was extensive archaeological excavation, uncovering millions of artifacts as well as the ruins of fortifications and buildings. Enough information was uncovered on site and discovered in archives in France, Britain, the United States, and Canada to recreate the fortress with accuracy. Louisbourg is North America's largest historic reconstruction.

**D.** Nowadays tourists can enjoy the lavishly reconstructed fortress. In the summer, 150 costumed actors are onsite. Men, women, and children in their period-style clothes act out activities representing society from poor labourers to the very rich. There are engineers, musicians, soldiers, merchants, street vendors, bakers, servants, and fishermen. Visitors can listen to music and stories, watch dances, and observe activities such as lace-making, cooking, gardening, and animal care. They can watch soldiers load and shoot a musket or fire a cannon. Visiting Louisbourg is stepping back 250 years in history.

**E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.**

## Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. Today's Louisbourg accurately reconstructs what life was like there in 1744.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. In the 18th century, both France and Britain wanted to control Louisbourg.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. Louisbourg is the most popular historical site in Canada.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. Today's visitors are entertained by numerous re-enactments.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. Fish was the most important commodity of 18th century Louisbourg.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. The British finally destroyed Louisbourg to remove the French from the area.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. Visitors to the site can participate in the 250-year old activities.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Louisbourg was the largest French settlement in North America in the 1700s.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Less than half of the original Louisbourg fortress has been restored. .

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

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PART 4

## Read the following article from a website.

It's a tradition. Thousands of Canadian children don skates and train in minor hockey leagues, some from the time they learn to walk. Good sportsmanship and teamwork are supposed to be the main lessons learned, but they've recently been overshadowed by the drive to win at any cost. Nowadays, belligerent parents, sometimes captured on YouTube, yell at their offspring to "hit harder" on the ice while they fight amongst themselves in the stands. Parents exchange insults, shoves, punches, slaps, and threats. Homicides have even occurred.

Only a small fraction of parents are guilty of this hockey madness, but their actions carry broad repercussions, including costly litigation, wasted resources, and damage to the reputation of a time-honoured sport. Now minor hockey organizations in most provinces try to safeguard players' enthusiasm by making parents pass a "respect in sports" course before their kids hit the ice.

At a recent community awareness event hosted by Sports4Kids, most parents interviewed bemoaned the current state of minor hockey, insisting that problems caused by a few were ruining things for everyone. Fredericton parent Janis Fanshaw said both her sons started playing at age 5, burned out after multiple injuries, and now, to her disappointment, shun all team sports. She blames her sons' injuries on "hockey parents who bullied their kids to bully mine." Former hockey parent Meg Nakamura felt her daughter had a milder experience with bullies, but a fair bit of peer pressure. "She eventually turned to soccer instead," Nakamura recalled.

Addressing the 100 attendees, Sports4Kids director Luigi Pubnico offered this advice to parents: "Let kids choose their own sports. They'll not only get off the couch and get moving, they'll excel at doing what they love. Just don't let them develop big egos—they're a lifelong hindrance." In the subsequent open-mic discussion, one parent, Jose Aldana, insisted that even reluctantly playing any competitive sport will give kids the self-discipline they need to succeed in life. However, self-described "recovering hockey dad" Steve Kosinski said, "Organized sports destroy a kid's spirit and bring out the worst in parents. Just forget organized sports entirely until your kid's at least eighteen."

## Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. According to the article, minor hockey improves players' _____
- ◯ activity level.
- ◯ self-esteem.
- ◯ peer relationships.
- ◯ self-discipline.

2. What is one result of hockey madness?
- ◯ fraudulent lawsuits
- ◯ injured hockey coaches
- ◯ parental training
- ◯ more soccer teams

3. According to the writer, what is the primary source of peer pressure?
- ◯ aggressive guardians
- ◯ egotistical coaches
- ◯ competitive siblings
- ◯ organized sports

4. Who would most want hockey parents to take the course?
- ◯ Janice Fanshaw
- ◯ Steve Kosinski
- ◯ Meg Nakamura
- ◯ Luigi Pubnico

5. Hockey madness can harm a child's _____
- ◯ personal reputation.
- ◯ competitive spirit.
- ◯ motivation to exercise.
- ◯ passion for sports.

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PART 4

**The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.**

I was one of the parents at the meeting, and, as one can glean from the article, the majority of parents who spoke 6. _____ minor hockey's present state. This being said, it's hard to buy into Kosinski's 7. _____ . Minor hockey was a disaster for my kids. However, consistent with what the Sports4Kids representative says, I think that's because they 8. _____ sport. In contrast, I completely disagree with one of his points and would argue that it's entirely possible for kids to 9. _____ . My overall takeaway from the article is that parents should strive to be 10. _____ .

6. ◯ argued in support of
   ◯ felt frustrated with
   ◯ regretted their role in
   ◯ were unsure how to fix

7. ◯ spiteful predictions
   ◯ angry accusations
   ◯ pessimistic outlook
   ◯ vengeful perspective

8. ◯ had difficulty choosing a
   ◯ were modest about their
   ◯ wanted to play a different
   ◯ needed a less competitive

9. ◯ choose hockey but still be bullied
   ◯ develop egos but still succeed
   ◯ make choices on their own
   ◯ play well but still want to quit

10. ◯ aggressive fans
    ◯ sideline coaches
    ◯ supportive spectators
    ◯ leaders in the community

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# Answer Key

| PART 1 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | sent Peter a birthday gift. |
| Question 2 | has had some guitar lessons. |
| Question 3 | visited the jungle with Ecuadorian guides. |
| Question 4 | began to enjoy the rainforest. |
| Question 5 | enjoying the last part of her trip. |
| Question 6 | people's goodwill. |
| Question 7 | can learn to drive |
| Question 8 | guitar lessons |
| Question 9 | harmful |
| Question 10 | being friendly |
| Question 11 | show the way |

| PART 2 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | application |
| Question 2 | customer service |
| Question 3 | cash registers |
| Question 4 | additional languages |
| Question 5 | City Foods |
| Question 6 | in person. |
| Question 7 | expanding. |
| Question 8 | arrange an interview. |

| PART 3 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | D |
| Question 2 | B |
| Question 3 | E |
| Question 4 | D |
| Question 5 | A |
| Question 6 | B |
| Question 7 | D |
| Question 8 | E |
| Question 9 | C |

| PART 4 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | peer relationships. |
| Question 2 | parental training |
| Question 3 | aggressive guardians |
| Question 4 | Janice Fanshaw |
| Question 5 | passion for sports. |
| Question 6 | felt frustrated with |
| Question 7 | pessimistic outlook |
| Question 8 | wanted to play a different |
| Question 9 | develop egos but still succeed |
| Question 10 | supportive spectators |

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